INSTRUCTIONAL AREA
Marketing

RETAIL MERCHANDISING SERIES EVENT

PARTICIPANT INSTRUCTIONS

(quoted directly from DECA, INC)

- "This event is presented to you through your review of the Career Competencies, Performance Indicators and Event Situation."
- "You have up to 10 minutes to review this information and prepare your presentation. Using the materials provided, you may make notes to use during your presentation."
- "You will have up to 10 minutes to present to the judge(s)."
- "You will be evaluated on your solution to the event situation, how you incorporate the performance indicators of this event and how you demonstrate the career competencies."
- "Turn in all your notes and event materials when you have completed the event."

SOLUTION

- Unique – Demonstrate original thinking, fresh perspectives and an insightful approach.
- Practical – Develop an actionable/viable solution in a real-world context.
- Effective – Develop a solution that achieves relevant outcomes.

CAREER COMPETENCIES

- Critical Thinking – Think critically to understand and solve problems.
- Communication – Communicate clearly, effectively and with reason.
- Decision Making – Consider the impacts of decisions.

PERFORMANCE INDICATORS

1. Describe connections between company actions and results (e.g., influencing consumer buying behavior, gaining market share, etc.).
2. Explain factors that influence customer/client/business buying behavior.
3. Explain the importance of merchandising to retailers.
4. Describe the use of technology in customer relationship management.
5. Describe factors used by marketers to position products/services.

EVENT SITUATION

You are to assume the role of the store manager at SOLE STATION, an independent sneaker boutique in a busy downtown shopping district. The owner (judge) wants you to recommend how SOLE STATION can win back sneaker shoppers who now buy directly from the big brands.

For 10 years, SOLE STATION was the place to get limited-release sneakers, and lines often wrapped around the block on release days. Over the past two years, the major sneaker brands have moved most limited releases to their own apps and websites. SOLE STATION's sales are down 22%, and release-day lines have disappeared. The store has an email list of 9,000 customers but doesn't use it to learn what those customers buy or want.

SOLE STATION still has strengths the brands' apps don't: a staff that knows sneaker culture, a wall display customers love to photograph, a cleaning and customizing service and strong ties with local high school and college athletes. The owner (judge) wants you to:

- Explain why sneaker shoppers have changed where they buy
- Recommend how SOLE STATION should position itself against the brands' own apps
- Explain how SOLE STATION can use technology and its customer list to build relationships
- Describe how merchandising in the store can bring shoppers back in person

You will present your ideas to the owner (judge) in a role-play to take place in the owner's (judge's) office. The owner (judge) will begin the role-play by greeting you and asking to hear your ideas. After you have presented your ideas and have answered the owner's (judge's) questions, the owner (judge) will conclude the role-play by thanking you for your work.

Possible Judge's Questions:

1. What should we learn about our 9,000 email customers, and how do we use it?
2. What changes in our store would you make first, and what results do you expect?

	Rate the participant's ability to:	Novice	Developing	Proficient	Exemplary	Judged Score
PERFORMANCE INDICATORS						
1.	Describe connections between company actions and results (e.g., influencing consumer buying behavior, gaining market share, etc.).	0-1-2-3	4-5-6	7-8-9	10	
2.	Explain factors that influence customer/client/business buying behavior.	0-1-2-3	4-5-6	7-8-9	10	
3.	Explain the importance of merchandising to retailers.	0-1-2-3	4-5-6	7-8-9	10	
4.	Describe the use of technology in customer relationship management.	0-1-2-3	4-5-6	7-8-9	10	
5.	Describe factors used by marketers to position products/services.	0-1-2-3	4-5-6	7-8-9	10	
SOLUTION						
4.	**Unique** Demonstrate original thinking, fresh perspectives and an insightful approach.	0-1-2	3-4-5	6-7	8	
5.	**Practical** Develop an actionable/viable solution in a real-world context.	0-1-2	3-4-5	6-7	8	
6.	**Effective** Develop a solution that achieves relevant outcomes	0-1-2	3-4-5	6-7	8	
CAEREER COMPETANCIES						
7.	**Critical Thinking** Think critically to understand and solve problems	0-1	2-3	4-5	6	
8.	**Communication** Communicate clearly, effectively and with reason.	0-1	2-3	4-5	6	
9.	**Decision Making** Consider the impacts of decisions.	0-1	2-3	4-5	6	
OVERALL IMPRESSIONS						
10.	Demonstrate overall career readiness through professionalism, poise and confidence.	0-1-2	3-4-5	6-7	8	
					TOTAL SCORE	